

TECHNOLOGY

TRANSISTOR RADIO

Developed in 1954, transistor radios were a must-have device in Vietnam, with 99 percent of American soldiers owning or having access to one. They used them to tune in to sanitized transmissions on the US Armed Forces Radio, but they also listened to rock music and defiant political commentary. North Vietnamese radio programs, with hosts such as “Hanoi Hannah,” played music for US troops, interspersed with anti-American propaganda and sometimes disturbingly accurate reports of battles and troop movements.



A PHILIPS RADIO

» AFTER

Major US construction projects continued in Vietnam even as America's role in the war began to decline.

BUILDING MORALE

Commanders at Long Binh Post—which already had a golf course, massage parlor, nightclubs, and more—planned to build a 1,690-acre (7 square km) recreational lake for swimming and fishing in 1970. They were forced to scrap the \$110,000 project due to negative media coverage, as public opinion in the United States railed **against the war**.

The gradual **withdrawal of US forces** would change the landscape of the war, as US bases were **turned over** to ARVN units—as Long Binh Post was in 1972—or abandoned to become **ghost towns**.